

An Act

ENROLLED SENATE
BILL NO. 1726

By: Daniels of the Senate

and

Caldwell (Chad) of the
House

An Act relating to higher education; requiring institutions of higher education utilizing graduate students as instructors to establish and maintain training for graduate student instructors; providing for contents of training; providing for codification; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

SUBJECT: Higher education

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3235 of Title 70, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. An institution of higher education within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education utilizing graduate students as instructors of record or as primary classroom instructors in undergraduate courses shall establish and maintain a formal training program to ensure such graduate instructors are adequately prepared for their instructional responsibilities.

B. The training required by subsection A of this section shall include effective teaching practices, classroom management, assessment and grading standards, student accommodations, academic integrity, and applicable institutional, state, and federal policies. The training shall also include instruction on the protection of students' rights under the First Amendment to the United States Constitution including the principles of free speech,

free inquiry, and viewpoint neutrality. The training shall emphasize that students shall not be penalized or disadvantaged in grading, participation, or evaluation on the basis of lawful expression.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the Senate the 14th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the 6th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____